

Human Physiology.

Course Syllabus · Section BIOL-5-D9286 · Sutter Internet (NET)

4.0 units · 15 weeks · September 8 to December 16, 2026

Fully online, lecture and lab · nothing meets at a set time · everything due Sunday at 10:00 pm

C-ID BIOL 120B · IGETC 5B and 5C · CSU GE B2 and B3 · Transferable to CSU and UC

Read this first How the course runs, what is graded, and every date you need.

Keep it It is the agreement between us for the whole term.

Also in Canvas The Competency Packet, listing everything this course asks you to be able to do, and the course schedule.

01 Course identification and catalog data

Course	BIO 005, Human Physiology
Units	4.0 semester units
Section	BIOL-5-D9286 · Sutter Internet (NET)
Term	Fall 2026, 15 weeks. Instruction begins September 8, 2026. Term ends December 16, 2026.
Format	Fully online, lecture and lab, on your own time. Nothing in this course meets at a set time. Everything is due Sunday at 10:00 pm.
Lecture instruction	Recorded concept lectures and slide decks in Canvas, worked against a weekly competency note sheet. This is where the content is taught.
Laboratory instruction	Weekly virtual labs in PhysioEx through Pearson, generating and interpreting real physiological output: traces, curves, values and calculations.
Instructor	Dr. Sharilyn Rennie
Level	Majors-level human physiology. Transfer-level laboratory science, taken by students heading into nursing, allied health, kinesiology and the biological sciences.
Prerequisite	BIOL 15 (Bioscience) or BIOL 1 (Principles of Biology). Recommended: eligibility for ENGL 1A and MATH 52, and basic computer skills.
Grading	Letter grade only. There is no Pass / No Pass option for this course.
Transfer	Transferable to both UC and CSU. IGETC Areas 5B and 5C. CSU GE Areas B2 and B3. C-ID BIOL 120B. Serves the Biology-Allied Health AS, Natural Science AS, Kinesiology AA-T, and the LVN-to-RN 30-Unit Option.

If you're heading toward nursing or another health program, check that program's specific requirements with a counselor. The contacts are in Section 15.

02 Instructor and contact

Instructor	Dr. Sharilyn Rennie
Email	srennie@yccd.edu
Best channel	Canvas Inbox. It keeps every course message in one place, which means I can find your history when you need me to.
Reply time	48 to 72 hours on weekdays. Please do not expect a same-day reply the night before a deadline.
Office hours	Wednesdays 9:00 to 10:00 am on Zoom . Drop in, no appointment needed. If that window never works with your schedule, message me and we will find another time.

Physiology builds on itself, so a small gap in September is a large one by November. Come and talk to me before you fall behind rather than after. That conversation is much easier for both of us while the gap is still small.

03 Course description and learning outcomes

Catalog description

Human Physiology introduces the physiological principles of function, integration, regulation and homeostasis of the human body. It includes topics at the molecular, cellular, tissue, and organ levels found within all eleven organ systems. Laboratory includes activities such as EEGs, EMGs, EKGs, blood tests, spirometric measurements, urinalysis, digestion experiments, and many others, simulated in this online section. The clinical aspects of evaluating and maintaining health are also discussed in lecture and laboratory.

This is a physiology course. We are after mechanism: what the body must accomplish, how it accomplishes it, and what happens when conditions change. Where anatomy appears, it appears because it explains a mechanism. What runs through all of it is

clinical context, because a mechanism you have seen matter to a real patient is a mechanism you remember.

Student learning outcomes

By the end of this course you should be able to:

- **Critical thinking.** Collect, analyze and evaluate scientific data and show you understand it.
- **Scientific awareness.** Understand the purpose of scientific inquiry and how basic scientific principles and the scientific method apply.
- **Communication.** Use language and nonverbal communication to describe and present scientific data and results to an audience.

These three outcomes are the official ones. The **Competency Packet** in Canvas, 268 specific things you'll be able to do, each one a single skill, sits underneath them, and every exam question in this course traces back to that list. Nothing is graded that isn't on it. The third outcome, communication, is exactly what the draw-and-teach midterms practice.

04 How this course works, and why it is built this way

This is a fully online course, which means nobody schedules your hours for you. So the course gives you a fixed weekly shape to pour them into, and inside that shape it gives you real choices about how you learn. Both halves of that sentence matter, and the rest of this section is about why.

One path, several ways to walk it, one standard at the end

Every week is a single page with the same seven steps in the same order. You never have to work out where to go next or what this week is about. What you do choose, every week, is how you get there.

YOU DO NOT CHOOSE	YOU DO CHOOSE
Where to go next	Which representation helps you learn: video, notes, textbook, or a combination
What the week is about	How you retrieve: drawing, brain dump, explaining out loud, rebuilding the process
What the competencies are	Which application case you solve, and which room it is set in
What is due, or when	Which support you use, and when in the week you work
What you have to be able to do at the end	What you change when something is not working

That balance is deliberate. A course with no choice in it ignores that you are all arriving from different places. A course that is nothing but choice hands you a menu and leaves you to work out what mattered. This one fixes the destination and opens up the route.

What mastery means here

If I am going to tell you that you choose how you learn, I owe you a reliable way to find out whether your choice actually produced learning. Otherwise choice quietly becomes **I watched the video, therefore I am done**, and that is not the same thing at all.

So here is the definition this course runs on. **You have not mastered something because you watched it, read it, highlighted it, or recognized it when you saw it. You have mastered a competency when you can retrieve what you know without your resources and use it to solve a problem you have not seen before.**

LEVEL	WHAT IT SOUNDS LIKE
1 · I recognize it	I have seen this before. It looks familiar.
2 · I can recall it	I can explain or reconstruct it without looking at anything.
3 · I can use it	I can apply it to a problem I have not seen before.
4 · I can reason with it	I can predict what happens when the system changes, and explain why.

In this course, mastery means levels 3 and 4, with recall as the foundation that makes either possible. Recognition is not on the list. It is the level that feels like understanding while you are reading and disappears the moment the notes are closed.

The Mastery Check, and why it has no points

Every week ends its learning half with a **Mastery Check**. It is not a quiz, and it is not called one, because the word quiz makes everyone think about points instead of about information. It is a real practice exam that you build yourself, on the week you are in.

- **No points, no penalty, and nothing about it reaches Canvas.** Its only job is to tell you whether the way you chose to learn that week worked.
- **You build it yourself.** Open the practice exam, tick the week you are in, choose 30 questions, and go. That takes about five seconds and it means the exam is yours rather than one handed to you.
- **Do not use your notes the first time.** If you look things up it will tell you what you can find. You already know you can find things. What you need to know is what you can retrieve.
- **Unlimited attempts, and every one is a different exam.** The bank holds about 5,600 questions, so sitting the same week twice measures whether you learned the physiology rather than whether you remembered the questions. Try, find the gap, relearn it, try again.
- **Five kinds of question, in the same mix every time.** Multiple choice, multiple answer, true or false where you have to make the false statement true, brain dumps you check against a rubric, and application questions. Roughly nine in ten sit above simple recall, because recognizing a right answer and being able to do physiology are not the same skill.
- **You rate your confidence before you check.** That is what lets the report separate a gap, where you were unsure and wrong, from a misconception, where you were sure and wrong. Those need completely different fixes, and the confident wrong ones are the expensive kind because they do not go away on their own.
- **You do get a score, and every attempt is logged.** That is on purpose. The score is not what you are graded on, but it is how improvement gets measured: the log keeps every exam you take, so you and I can both see whether the numbers are moving over a run of attempts rather than guessing from one.
- **The score is not the most useful part of the report, though.** Underneath it you get your score by week, the competencies to review, the ones you got wrong while you felt confident, and how this attempt compares with your last one on the same weeks. That is what tells you what to do next.

- **One exam does not cover a week.** Thirty questions sample it. A competency you have never been asked about is not one you have proved, which is the real reason to come back and build another.

The report lists the competencies to review and never the questions or the answers, so you can upload it. That is the **weekly practice log**, and it carries no points either: I read it to see who is practicing and who might want a hand before an exam, not to grade anybody.

Then the discussion closes the loop. It does not ask what study strategy you used. It asks what the check revealed, what you did about it, and what happened when you tried again. That is evidence of your thinking, and it is gradeable without anyone having to grade your learning process itself.

Where the effort actually goes

Your first meeting with every concept is the weekly **note sheet**, built from that week's competencies. It is not graded, and doing it before anything else is the single habit that makes the rest of the week work. Come to the videos and the reading with questions already in hand and they answer something. Come cold and they wash over you.

The **Mastery OS** runs spaced recall cards, also ungraded, so material from Week 3 is still there in October when Midterm 1 asks for it.

And the **application cases** are where the physiology stops being a subject and becomes something you do. You pick the room. The reasoning is the same in all of them.

05 The weekly rhythm

Seven steps, the same seven every week, in the same order, on one page. Learn the shape once in Week 1 and the term runs on rails.

STEP	THE QUESTION IT ANSWERS	GRADED
Mission	What problem are we trying to understand this week?	No
1 · Learn	Build what you need to know. Choose your format.	No
2 · Retrieve	Can you reconstruct it without looking?	No
3 · Practice	Can you use it? Predict, commit, check, correct, explain.	No
4 · Mastery Check	Did the way you learned it actually work?	No
5 · Investigate	What does the evidence show?	Yes, 25%
6 · Apply	Choose a case. Use the physiology.	Yes, 25%
7 · Reflect	What did the evidence tell you, and what did you do with it?	Yes, 15%

The branch at step 4

The Mastery Check sits where it does on purpose. It is the gate between learning the material and using it, and it sends you one of two ways.

- **All competencies solid.** Move to Investigate and Apply. Do not keep reviewing material you can already use, it is the least valuable hour available to you.
- **Not yet.** You will be told exactly which competency, and given a different resource to try. Retrieve and practice that one thing, then retake the check. Then move on.

Going round that loop twice is not falling behind. It is the course working the way it was built to work, and it costs far less than arriving at a midterm having found out too late.

Everything graded is due Sunday at 10:00 pm. One due day, every week, all fifteen weeks. The one exception: your initial discussion post is due Friday at 10:00 pm so there is something for your classmates to reply to, and replies are due Sunday with everything else. Within that, when you work is yours. Five in the morning before a shift,

nine at night once the house is quiet, or the whole thing on a Saturday. The order above is the order that works. The schedule is yours.

06 Course materials and technology

Required

- **Canvas**, the college learning management system. You already have access through your Yuba account. Canvas is the system of record for this course.
- **Pearson Mastering A&P with PhysioEx**. Your labs run on it, and the eText of our book, **Human Physiology: An Integrated Approach** by Dee Unglaub Silverthorn, 9th edition, comes with it for free. **Buy it one way, the right way**: open our Canvas course, click **Access Pearson** in the left-hand menu, and purchase there. That path gives you the correct package at the best price, registered to our course automatically. Please don't buy access codes from Amazon or other websites. Many won't work with our course, can't be refunded, and are a waste of your money. You need this from the first week.
- **A device and reliable internet** that will run Canvas, Pearson and the Mastery OS, plus **a camera** (a phone is fine) for recording your draw-and-teach videos.
- **Paper and pens**. Homework in this course is handwritten and hand-drawn (Section 11), so you need a way to write, draw, and photograph or scan your work into a PDF for Canvas.

Free course tools, set up in Week 1

- **Mastery OS**, the study app. Browser-based and free. Tracks your competencies, runs spaced recall, and shows you where you are weak.
- **Concept lectures**, the recorded lecture videos and slide decks. This is where the content is taught.
- **The Competency Packet**, the full list of what this course asks of you and what it assumes you arrive with, with self-checks.

07 Grading and assessment

Four categories, and each one is named for what it asks you to do rather than for the format it arrives in. The work that carries the most weight is the work that proves the reasoning is yours.

Show Me What You Know 35%	Investigate It 25%	Use It 25%	Think About It 15%
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CATEGORY	WHAT IT IS	WEIGHT
Show Me What You Know	Two midterm exams, draw and teach on video. No notes.	35%
Investigate It	Weekly labs. PhysioEx, the repo labs, and the data records that go with them.	25%
Use It	The weekly application case you choose, and the patient file you build across the term.	25%
Think About It	The weekly discussion, carrying the physiology and your thinking about it in one post.	15%

Show Me What You Know, 35 percent

- These are not multiple choice tests. Each midterm asks you to **draw a physiological pathway and teach it to me** on video, out loud, with no notes. Draw the mechanism, label it, explain each step and say why it happens.
- The format is chosen for a reason. Recognizing the right answer on a list and being able to build the answer from nothing are different skills, and only one of them is any use to you in a clinical program.
- **Midterm 1** covers Weeks 1 to 7. **Midterm 2** covers Weeks 8 to 14. Each is worth 17.5 percent.
- **Each is a window, not an hour.** Midterm 1 opens Monday, October 26 at 8:00 am and closes Wednesday, October 28 at 10:00 pm. Midterm 2 opens Monday, December 14 at 8:00 am and closes Wednesday, December 16 at 10:00 pm. Each window sits at the front of its week so the week before it is finished and the week it sits in is still open to you afterwards.
- You will not be surprised by the format. Every week's Retrieve step is this exact task in miniature, ungraded.

Investigate It, 25 percent

- One lab a week, aligned to that week's material. You generate and interpret real physiological output: a trace, a curve, a set of values, a calculation.

- Every lab uses the same reasoning structure, and it is the structure a clinical write up uses too: question, prediction, evidence, interpretation, conclusion. You write the prediction before you see the data. That order is not optional, and it is where most of the learning is.
- **Where the lab uses PhysioEx, it takes both halves.** PhysioEx must show complete in Pearson, and you must turn in the worksheet and data record. The points live on the worksheet. PhysioEx carries no points and is only the gate. Clicking through PhysioEx alone earns nothing, and a worksheet with no PhysioEx behind it does not get graded.

Use It, 25 percent

- Every week gives you three or four **application cases** set in different rooms: nursing, medicine, radiology, and exercise or allied health. **You choose one.** They differ in context. They do not differ in rigor, and every one of them assesses the same underlying competency.
- Whichever case you choose, it asks the same five things: name the physiological variable and the system regulating it, predict what is happening, explain the mechanism step by step, interpret the evidence you were given, and justify your conclusion including what would change it.
- The cases accumulate into **your patient file**, which is the capstone. By Week 15 you are holding a body of your own reasoning across every system in the course, in the setting you are actually heading for.
- This is the category where the choice is real and the standard is not. You pick the room. The physiology you have to be able to do in it is fixed.

Think About It, 15 percent

- One post a week, not two. It carries the physiology and your thinking about it together, in one post.
- What it asks for is a **decision, the evidence, and the adjustment.** What did your Mastery Check reveal? What did you do about it? What happened when you tried again? And one question about the physiology itself, which changes each week.
- **Do not post your Mastery Check result.** Not the number, not how many attempts. Nobody learns anything from that, and it turns the thread into a leaderboard. What is worth reading is what you changed and whether it worked.
- Your initial post is due Friday at 10:00 pm so there is something to reply to. Peer replies are due Sunday at 10:00 pm.

What is not graded, and why that is deliberate

Several things you will do every week carry no points at all.

- **The note sheet and the retrieval work.** This is where you find out what you do not know. Grading it would push you to make it look finished instead of making it honest, and an honest sheet with gaps in it is worth more to you than a tidy one.
- **The practice items and the book problems.** Predict, commit, check, correct, explain. Getting these wrong is the point of doing them. The book problems sit in Learn and Retrieve with two routes through them: work them forwards if you have a way in, or work them backwards, reading a solution and writing beside each line why that step is there before reproducing it from blank paper. The second route is for the problems you open and cannot start. It is not the easy option, it is usually the slower one, and it is a real way to learn a hard topic rather than a way around it.
- **The Mastery Check.** No points, no penalty, and as many attempts as you want. It does score you, and it reports competency by competency so you know what to go back to. The score is for you; none of it reaches the gradebook. See section 04 for why it works that way.

None of this is optional in any way that matters. It is the entire route to the four graded categories above, and the students who skip it are the ones who arrive at a midterm able to recognize a pathway and unable to draw one.

08 Grading scale and the workload

Fixed scale, applied to your final weighted percentage. There is no curve.

A

89.5 to 100%

B

79.5 to 89.4%

C

69.5 to 79.4%

D

59.5 to 69.4%

F

0 to 59.4%

The workload, honestly

California community colleges follow the Carnegie standard, and by the official course outline this 4–unit course is **216 learning hours**: 144 hours of instruction plus 72 of study. Over our 15 weeks, that's an official floor of about **14 hours a week**. A floor is what it takes to pass, roughly, it is not a promise of what it takes to do well.

Realistically, plan on 16 to 20 hours a week to genuinely learn this material: to walk into a midterm able to draw a pathway and teach it with no notes, not just recognize it.

If you need an A or a B, budget 20 hours, and sometimes closer to 30. Most of you are headed for nursing or other health programs that require an A or B in this course; a C won't get you in. What it actually takes depends on the grade you're going for, your experience as a student, and your background. If you haven't had anatomy yet, or you're taking it at the same time as this course, you'll be teaching yourself the parts of the body on your own time while learning how they work in mine, and that's real added hours. The Competency Packet lists exactly what the course assumes you arrive with, so you can see your own gaps in Week 1 instead of discovering them in Week 6.

I would rather you knew all of this in September than discovered it in October. Load the early weeks heavily. Physiology compounds, and so does falling behind in it. This is a mastery-based course: attending and turning things in does not by itself earn the grade. The study hours are what do.

09 Course schedule

15 weeks, two midterms. Each window sits at the front of a week, so the block before it is finished and the week it sits in stays open to you. Week titles below are what you'll see in Canvas; the reading and assignments for each week are on that week's page.

WK	OPENS	WEEK
1	Sep 8	How physiology works and what keeps you steady
2	Sep 14	The chemistry that does work in the body
3	Sep 21	Getting across the membrane
4	Sep 28	How cells talk, and the electrical signal
5	Oct 5	Synapses and central integration
6	Oct 12	Sensing the world, and the responses you do not control
7	Oct 19	Muscle, and how movement gets commanded
Midterm 1 · Weeks 1 to 7 · window Mon Oct 26, 8:00 am to Wed Oct 28, 10:00 pm		
8	Oct 26	Hormones and reproduction, the slow control system
9	Nov 2	The heart as a pump
10	Nov 9	Pressure, flow, and holding blood pressure steady
11	Nov 16	Blood and how the body defends itself
12	Nov 23	Digestion, and how you use food for fuel · Thanksgiving week, plan ahead
13	Nov 30	Breathing, gas transport, and the fast pH lever
14	Dec 7	The kidney and body fluid balance
Midterm 2 · Weeks 8 to 14 · window Mon Dec 14, 8:00 am to Wed Dec 16, 10:00 pm		
15	Dec 14	The slow pH lever, and putting it all together · three days only

If a date has to move I will announce it in Canvas. Grade weights and exam policy will not change.

10 Attendance, participation and enrollment

In an online course, participation is submitted work. There is no roll call. What counts as attending is the **graded work coming in**: your discussion post, your lab, and your weekly application case. The note sheet, the practice and the Mastery Check matter enormously to your learning, but they carry no points and I cannot certify attendance from them, so they are not what the college looks at. Staying enrolled and staying current are the same thing here.

- **Week 1 is mandatory.** Turn in Week 1's graded work: the introduction discussion, the vision board discussion and the reference range lab. A student who submits nothing in the first weeks can be dropped as a no-show, and the seat goes to the waitlist.
- **Census is September 27.** I certify who is actively participating. If nothing has come in by then, I am required to report you as not attending, and you can be dropped. Don't let a registration date end your semester in Week 3.
- **Get into Canvas at least three times a week** and turn on announcement notifications, because that is where a schedule change or an exam-window note appears first.

Dropping the course is yours to do

If you decide to leave the course, you have to formally drop it yourself through your student portal. Do not assume I have done it for you, and do not assume it happens on its own. A course you walked away from but never dropped becomes an F you did not need to earn. The Fall 2026 deadlines are in Section 14.

11 Academic integrity and the use of AI

Academic honesty

Cheating and plagiarism are not tolerated in this course. A violation earns at least a zero on the work in question, may result in an F for the course, and is reported for disciplinary action under college policy. Complete your own work, and ask me if you are not sure where the line falls. Asking is always the cheaper option.

Handwritten means handwritten

Unless an assignment says otherwise, everything you turn in is handwritten and hand-drawn. Typed work earns a zero.

This isn't nostalgia. Drawing a pathway by hand is how your brain builds it, and it's how the midterms work, so it's how the practice works. Read the directions on every assignment before you start; work that ignores the directions can't be redone.

Using AI

For studying, AI is encouraged. Tools like ChatGPT and Claude are useful for the same things a good study partner is useful for: explaining a concept a second way, quizzing you, helping you plan your week. Teaching a concept to something that asks follow-up questions is one of the better ways to find out whether you actually have it.

For graded work, the rules are strict. What you turn in must be your own work, in your own hand, from your own head. Turning in AI-written work as yours is cheating, and no outside help of any kind is allowed during exams.

Here's the honest reason, beyond the rules: the midterms are the single largest piece of your grade at 35 percent, and they're you, on camera, teaching with no notes. A tool that does your weekly work for you is quietly taking the practice you'll desperately want back in exam week. Nobody can outsource their own understanding.

The full picture, including how I use AI to build this course and the complete lists of where you can and cannot use it, is on the [How AI is used in this course ↗](#) page.

No extra credit

There's no individual extra credit, and asking for it won't create any. If I ever offer extra credit, I offer it to the whole class at once.

12 Due dates, late work and make-ups

Everything is due Sunday at 10:00 pm. Discussions run ahead of that: the initial post is due Friday at 10:00 pm and peer replies Sunday at 10:00 pm. Up to 24 hours late: automatic 50% reduction. After 24 hours: zero, no make-up. There are no exceptions, not for family, travel, work, other obligations, or emergencies.

I know that sounds strict, so here is the honest reasoning. This course never requires you to be anywhere at any particular time. You can do every bit of this work at whatever hour of whatever day fits your life, and the next week is always open before you need it. That means the cushion for life's surprises is built in before the deadline, not after it. If you know a trip, a busy stretch at work, or a family event is coming, work ahead the week before. If something unexpected lands on a Saturday, the week's work shouldn't have been waiting on that Saturday.

This is the trade the course asks of you: total freedom over your hours, in exchange for full responsibility for them. Nobody takes attendance, so nobody rescues a deadline either. Students who pick their work times at the start of the week and protect them do very well here. Students who plan to "find time Sunday" usually find something else instead.

You can work one week ahead. Two weeks are open at any time: the week you are in and the week after it. If you know a hard stretch is coming, get the next week done early. You can't open more than one week ahead, and that limit is deliberate: covering four weeks of physiology in a weekend feels productive and holds almost nothing. Weeks you have finished stay open all term.

Submit early. The internet fails, computers crash, and files refuse to upload, always at 11:58 pm. A submission that exists on Thursday can't be lost on Sunday.

If something serious happens in your life, come and talk to me about your options in the course as a whole, including the withdrawal deadline in Section 14. What I can't do is reopen a deadline for one student that everyone else met under the same conditions.

13 Accessibility and accommodation

Your success matters to me. This course is designed to be welcoming to and usable by everyone: English-language learners, students with disabilities, students returning to school after time away, and students new to online courses. If any part of the course gets in the way of your learning, tell me as soon as possible and we will build strategies together.

Office	Disabled Student Programs & Services (DSPS), Building 1800, Marysville campus
Phone	(530) 741-6795
Email	dspsinfo@yccd.edu
Fax	(530) 741-6942

Yuba College provides reasonable accommodations for students with documented disabilities under the ADA and Section 504. Apply with DSPS, submit your documentation, and schedule an intake appointment by phone, Zoom, or in person; you never have to come to campus.

Set this up in Week 1. You are responsible for sending me your approved accommodations early in the term. Accommodations are not retroactive, so work you have already submitted cannot be re-graded under accommodation. Your information stays confidential; I only ever see the approved accommodation, never the paperwork behind it. Accommodations adjust how you show what you know, never what the course asks of you.

14 Registration deadlines and important dates

These dates govern your enrollment, your money, and your transcript. Diary them today.

DATE	DEADLINE
Tue Sep 8	Instruction begins. Week 1 opens. The term starts on a Tuesday, so Week 1 is a short week.
Sun Sep 27	Census. Participation is certified from submitted work. No work in means being reported as not attending, and possibly dropped.
Sat Nov 21	Last day to drop with a W , without academic penalty. After this date you receive a letter grade, whatever it is.
Wed Dec 16	Term ends. Final work is due.

Check your schedule bill in your student portal for any class-specific add, refund, and no-record drop deadlines, those dates come from Admissions and Records, and short-term sections run on their own calendar. November 21 is the one people miss. If this course is not going to work out, the difference between deciding on November 20 and deciding on November 22 is the difference between a W and an F on your transcript forever, and Section 02 tells you how to reach me before it comes to that.

15 Student support, and where to find help

Start with me: Canvas Inbox, email, or Wednesday office hours. For everything else, these are real offices with real people, already paid for by your enrollment, and almost all of them work with you online.

- **Counseling.** Academic, career, and personal counseling, with online appointments. (530) 634-7766 · yubacounseling@yccd.edu · yc.yccd.edu/student/counseling
- **Tutoring.** Free through the college, in person and online, including at the Sutter County Center. (530) 751-5558 · yc.yccd.edu/student/tutoring
- **DSPS.** Accommodations and disability services. (530) 741-6795 · dspinfo@yccd.edu. See Section 13.
- **EOPS/CARE.** Counseling, books, and services for eligible students. (530) 741-6995 · yceops@yccd.edu
- **Basic needs.** Dusty's Food Pantry and Basic Needs can help with food, housing, and more. If you are hungry or unsure where you are sleeping, start here. It will not change how I grade you. yc.yccd.edu/student/dustys-food-pantry

If you're in crisis. If it's a life-threatening emergency, call **911** or go to the nearest emergency room. The **988 Suicide & Crisis Lifeline** is free, confidential, and answers 24/7: call or text 988. Sutter-Yuba Behavioral Health runs 24-hour local crisis services: **(530) 673-8255** or toll-free **(888) 923-3800**. During business hours, Yuba College Counseling can also help: (530) 634-7766.

Physiology can wait. You matter more than any deadline in this course. Reach out, and then message me and we'll sort the rest.

This syllabus

This syllabus is the course agreement between us for Fall 2026, written to be consistent with the approved Course Outline of Record for BIOL 5 and with college policy. Where a course rule here and a college policy could be read differently, college policy governs. I may adjust dates or activities as the term goes and will announce any change in Canvas. Grade weights and exam policy will not change.

16 A final word

Prepare, keep the rhythm, and submit early.

This course asks real work, and I will not pretend otherwise. But the design is on your side. Every week has the same five steps in the same order. The note sheet meets every idea before it's tested, the practice rounds rehearse the exam format until it's familiar, and the recall cards tell you what you actually know before a grade depends on it. Nothing in this course is a surprise. The whole of it is published in the Competency Packet on day one.

Keep the weekly rhythm, do the prepare step, and reach out early when you need help. Your grade is feedback, not a verdict. Keep showing up, and keep going. I am rooting for you.

Dr. Sharilyn Rennie

Yuba College